

[MAAT]
MOOR ASCENSION AND TRIUMPH: THE LAB

How to Create an Ebook

Your First Digital Product

*A complete guide to packaging your knowledge, story, and wisdom
into a sellable digital product — from blank page to first sale.*

7

CHAPTERS

30+

TEMPLATES

\$27–\$97

PRICE RANGE

SID MORRISON WASHINGTON · FOUNDER, MAAT · maatscrolls.lovable.app

CONTENTS

What You Will Learn

Introduction — Why Your Knowledge is a Product	3
Chapter One — Choosing Your Ebook Topic	4
Chapter Two — Defining Your Reader	5
Chapter Three — Structuring Your Ebook	6
Chapter Four — Writing the Content	7
Chapter Five — Designing Your Ebook	8
Chapter Six — Pricing and Packaging	9
Chapter Seven — Publishing and Selling	10
Appendix — Templates, Checklists, and Tools	11

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

Read linearly from beginning to end to build your first ebook from scratch. Or jump directly to the chapter you need right now. Every chapter ends with a checklist. Every tool recommendation is free or low-cost. By the end of Chapter Seven, you will have a sellable product.

INTRODUCTION

Why Your Knowledge Is a Product

You already have everything you need to create your first ebook. You have been collecting it your entire life.

Every problem you have solved, every system you have built, every hard lesson you have absorbed and transformed into wisdom — that is your inventory. Most people never monetize it because they were never taught that they could. They were taught to trade time for money. To go to a job. To serve someone else's institution.

This guide exists to close that gap.

An ebook is not a book. It is not a novel. It is not an academic paper. An ebook — in the context of the digital product economy — is a packaged system of knowledge, delivered in a readable format, that solves a specific problem for a specific person who is willing to pay for the solution.

"Your knowledge is not just something you know. It is something someone else needs — and is already looking for."

— Sid Morrison Washington

What makes ebooks powerful:

- **Create once, sell forever.** You build it once and it can generate income indefinitely — without your active involvement.
- **Zero inventory.** No warehouse. No shipping. No physical limit on how many people can buy it.
- **Immediate delivery.** The moment someone pays, they receive the product. No waiting.
- **Low barrier to entry.** You do not need a publisher, a designer, or a large audience to get started.
- **Scalable pricing.** An ebook can sell for \$7 or \$197 depending on the specificity and depth of the solution it provides.

The Orchard Podcast taught you that your network is already built. This guide will teach you that your product is already built too. You just have to package it.

CHAPTER ONE

Choosing Your Ebook Topic

The right topic is not the one you are most passionate about. It is the intersection of what you know deeply, what someone needs urgently, and what they are already paying for.

The Three-Circle Model

Before you write a single word, you need to find the intersection of three things. Think of it as three overlapping circles. Where they meet is your ebook topic.

Circle 1: WHAT YOU KNOW

Your skills, experience, hard-won lessons, systems, or expertise. This is anything you have figured out — in business, parenting, finance, health, relationships, creativity, spirituality, or any other domain where you have real results.

Circle 2: WHAT PEOPLE NEED

A specific, pressing problem that a defined group of people cannot solve on their own. Not a vague category — a specific pain. "I don't know how to start a business" is vague. "I don't know how to file my first LLC and protect my assets" is specific.

Circle 3: WHAT PEOPLE PAY FOR

Evidence that people are already spending money on solutions in this area. Books on Amazon. Courses on Udemy. Coaches charging for consultations. If no one is selling solutions in this space, it is a signal — but not always. If many people are, it is confirmation.

Topic Validation Questions

Before committing to a topic, answer these five questions honestly. If you can answer at least four of them clearly, you have a viable ebook topic.

- Can I describe the reader's problem in one sentence — without using the word "things"?
- Does this problem have a measurable outcome? (Something the reader can achieve or feel or have after reading?)
- Are there at least 3 other products (books, courses, coaches) selling solutions to a similar problem?
- Can I teach this from personal experience, not just research?
- Could I write 20–40 pages on this topic without running out of substance?

MAAT EXAMPLE

A MAAT community member with 15 years of experience managing household finances could write: "The Family P&L;: How to Run Your Household Like a Business in 30 Days." The reader is clear. The problem is clear. The outcome is measurable. The topic is specific. This is a sellable ebook at \$27–\$47.

Common Topic Mistakes

- **Too broad:** "Everything I know about entrepreneurship" — This is not a product. It is a library.
- **Too vague:** "How to be successful" — Success is not a problem. No one searches for it that way.
- **No specific reader:** "For everyone who wants to do better" — Everyone is no one.
- **No outcome:** "Thoughts on wealth and community" — Inspiration is not enough. The reader needs to DO something.
- **Already done perfectly:** "Everything about getting out of debt" — Ramsey already wrote it. Find your specific angle.

CHAPTER TWO

Defining Your Reader

The biggest mistake first-time ebook creators make is writing for everyone. When you write for everyone, you reach no one. The more specific your reader, the more powerfully your words land.

Build Your Reader Profile

Your reader is not a demographic. They are a person — with a specific situation, a specific frustration, and a specific hope. Answer these questions as if you are describing one real person you know.

Who are they?

Age range, life stage, family situation, professional context. Not to stereotype — to speak directly.

What is their current situation?

Where are they right now in relation to the problem your ebook solves? What does their daily reality look like?

What have they already tried?

This is critical. If they have tried generic advice and it failed, your ebook needs to explain why the generic approach did not work — before offering yours.

What do they want?

The outcome. Not the topic. The desired state on the other side of reading your book.

What is stopping them?

The real obstacle. Time? Money? Information? Mindset? Courage? Your ebook should directly address this.

Where do they spend time?

Online and offline. This will matter when you market the ebook later.

THE READER TEST

Write a single sentence that starts with: "This ebook is for _____ who want to _____ so that they can _____." If you cannot fill in all three blanks clearly and specifically, your reader is not defined yet. Come back to this sentence before you write a single chapter.

The Transformation Arc

Every ebook that sells has a clear transformation arc. The reader enters in State A and exits in State B. Your job as the author is to bridge that gap with clarity, story, and practical instruction.

State A: Where They Start	State B: Where They Finish
Confused about how to start an LLC	Has a filed LLC and an operating agreement
Spending randomly, no budget	Running a monthly household P&L;
Children receive no financial education at home	Has a curriculum for each age: 12, 16, 18, 25
Has knowledge but no digital product	Has a complete, priced, published ebook

CHAPTER THREE

Structuring Your Ebook

Structure is not just organization. Structure is the experience your reader has as they move through your content. A well-structured ebook feels inevitable — like each chapter is the natural next step.

The Core Ebook Architecture

Most successful ebooks follow a proven structural pattern. You do not need to reinvent this. Use it. Adapt it to your voice.

-
- 01 Cover & Title Page**
Your title, subtitle, author name. The title should contain either the problem or the outcome. Ideally both.
 - 02 Introduction / The Promise**
Who this is for. What they will be able to do by the end. Why you are qualified to teach it. Set the expectation immediately.
 - 03 The Problem Chapter**
Name the pain clearly. Validate that it is real and that the reader is not alone. Show that you understand it from the inside.
 - 04 Core Content Chapters (3–6)**
These are the chapters that deliver the system, the steps, or the framework. Each chapter should have one clear lesson with actionable application.
 - 05 The Bridge Chapter**
Connect the content to the reader's next move. What do they do now? Where do they go from here?
 - 06 The CTA Chapter / Closing**
Your offer. Your community. Your next product. A clear invitation to continue the journey with you.
-

07

Appendix / Resources

Templates, checklists, tools, and references. This section often doubles the perceived value of the ebook.

Chapter Construction Formula

Each content chapter should follow the same internal structure. This creates rhythm — the reader learns what to expect and moves through your content efficiently.

- **Hook:** A question, statement, or story that orients the reader to why this chapter matters.
- **Core Lesson:** The one idea, principle, or framework this chapter teaches. Only one.
- **Explanation:** How it works. Why it matters. Evidence or story that proves the point.
- **Application:** What the reader does with this lesson. A specific action, exercise, or decision.
- **Recap & Bridge:** One-sentence summary of the chapter. One sentence pointing to the next.

EBOOK LENGTH GUIDE

Short (20–40 pages): Focused how-to guides, checklists, frameworks. Price: \$7–\$27. Mid (40–80 pages): Full systems, multi-step processes, deeper education. Price: \$27–\$67. Long (80–150 pages): Comprehensive guides, workbook-style, with templates. Price: \$47–\$97. More pages is not always more value. Specific and actionable always beats thorough and vague.

CHAPTER FOUR

Writing the Content

Most people get stuck here. Not because they have nothing to say — because they are trying to write perfectly instead of writing clearly. Your first draft is not your final draft. Your first draft is just getting it out.

The Brain Dump Method

Before you write any chapter, do a brain dump. Set a timer for 15 minutes. Write everything you know about the topic of that chapter — without editing, without organizing, without stopping. Just get it out.

After the brain dump, you will have more than you need. Your job then becomes organizing and editing — which is a different (and easier) cognitive mode than creating.

Writing Principles

- **Write like you talk.** Read every sentence out loud. If you would never say it in conversation, rewrite it.
- **One idea per paragraph.** If a paragraph contains two ideas, it contains one paragraph too many.
- **Use specifics, not generalities.** "Save money" is a generality. "Set up an automatic transfer of \$200 per paycheck to a savings account you cannot see" is specific.
- **Name the reader's doubt.** If a reader is likely to resist a point you are making, say so. "I know what you are thinking..." disarms resistance before it forms.
- **Short sentences are powerful.** Vary your length. But when you want impact, go short.
- **End every chapter with action.** Not reflection. Action. What does the reader DO in the next 24 hours?

Using AI to Write Faster (Without Losing Your Voice)

AI tools like Claude, ChatGPT, and Gemini can dramatically speed up your writing process — if you use them correctly. The mistake most people make is asking AI to write their ebook for them. That produces generic content in a voice that is not yours.

Use AI for:

- Generating first-draft outlines that you then rewrite in your voice
- Expanding a bullet point into a paragraph when you are stuck
- Suggesting alternative ways to explain a concept you are struggling to articulate
- Writing the first draft of a section that you then heavily edit
- Creating the appendix templates, checklists, and resource lists
- Generating title and subtitle options (from the MAAT AI Prompt Vault)

Never use AI for:

- Your origin story or personal testimony — this must come from you
- Your specific examples — AI cannot know what you have lived
- Your final voice — always edit AI output back into your natural register

WRITING SPRINT SCHEDULE

Week 1: Introduction + Chapter 1 + Chapter 2 (target: 8–12 pages) Week 2: Chapter 3 + Chapter 4 + Chapter 5 (target: 12–18 pages) Week 3: Chapter 6 + Appendix + Closing (target: 8–12 pages) Week 4: Full edit pass, design, and publish. Total: 30–40 pages in 30 days. One committed hour per day.

CHAPTER FIVE

Designing Your Ebook

Design is not decoration. Design is communication. A well-designed ebook signals to the buyer that you take your work seriously — which signals that they should take you seriously.

Free and Low-Cost Design Tools

Tool	Where	Best For
Canva (Free)	canva.com	The most accessible ebook design tool. Has dedicated ebook templates. Drag-and-drop. No design experience needed. Export as PDF.
Adobe Express (Free)	express.adobe.com	Adobe's simplified design tool. Better typography control than Canva. Also has ebook templates.
Google Slides (Free)	slides.google.com	Surprisingly effective for simple ebook layouts. Set slide size to 8.5x11 or 6x9. Download as PDF.
Microsoft Word / Google Docs	Free	For text-heavy ebooks with minimal design. Use heading styles consistently. Export to PDF with one click.
Designrr (\$27+)	designrr.io	Purpose-built ebook creator. Can import a Google Doc or blog post and automatically format it into a designed ebook.

Design Essentials

- **Cover:** This is your most important design asset. Use a clear title, a strong visual, and your name. It must look good at thumbnail size — test it at 150px wide.
- **Typography:** Use two fonts maximum. One for headings. One for body text. Never more than two. Sans-serif for headings, serif for body text is a classic combination.
- **Color palette:** Choose 2–3 colors and use them consistently throughout. Your brand colors if you have them. Neutrals if you do not.
- **White space:** Do not fill every inch of every page. Breathing room makes content readable. Dense pages cause readers to skip.
- **Page numbers:** Always. Readers reference them. They signal professionalism.
- **Consistent headers:** Use the same style for every chapter title, every section header, every callout box. Consistency is what makes design look designed.

MAAT BRAND NOTE

If your ebook is a MAAT product, maintain the brand aesthetic: deep backgrounds, gold accents, serif typography, and sacred geometry elements where appropriate. The Scrolls of Maat have a visual language. Every product that carries the MAAT name should feel like it belongs to the same world.

CHAPTER SIX

Pricing and Packaging

Price is not a reflection of how long it took you to make something. Price is a reflection of how much the transformation is worth to the person buying it.

The Pricing Framework

Ebooks exist across a wide price spectrum. Where yours lands depends on three variables: the specificity of the problem it solves, the depth of the transformation it delivers, and the perceived authority of the person selling it.

Price	What It Signals	Best For
\$7–\$17	Impulse buy. Low friction. Entry-level trust.	Lead magnets, first-time customers, list growth, low-awareness audience.
\$27–\$47	Considered buy. Buyer is committed to the problem.	Specific frameworks, step-by-step systems, buyers who know they have the problem.
\$67–\$97	Premium buy. High specificity, high outcome.	Comprehensive guides, workbooks with templates, expert authority, warm audiences.

Packaging That Increases Perceived Value

The same ebook at the same price point will sell more if it is packaged with the right bonuses. Bonuses shift the question in the buyer's mind from "Is this worth the price?" to "I would be foolish not to buy this."

- **Checklists and worksheets:** Printable action tools that accompany the content. Dramatically increase completion rates and perceived value.
- **Templates:** Done-for-you documents the reader can fill in rather than create from scratch. A single good template can justify the purchase price alone.
- **Audio version:** Record yourself reading the ebook. Some buyers prefer to listen. Add it as a bonus for no additional creation time.
- **Resource list:** A curated list of tools, books, services, or communities related to the topic. One page of links has real value when it saves the reader hours of research.
- **Access to a community:** If you have a paid community or Lab, offer a 30-day trial. This converts ebook buyers into ongoing members.

CHAPTER SEVEN

Publishing and Selling

You do not need a publisher. You do not need a literary agent. You do not need a following of ten thousand people. You need a PDF, a price, and a place to sell it.

Where to Publish

Platform	URL	Monthly	Per Sale	Best For
Gumroad	gumroad.com	Free	10%	Easiest to start. Excellent discovery. Used by many independent creators. Instant payout.
Stan Store	stan.store	\$29/mo	0%	Built for creators. Social-media-first checkout. No per-sale fee. Great for TikTok/Instagram.
Payhip	payhip.com	Free	5%	Clean checkout. Pay-what-you-want option. Good for bundling products.
Lemon Squeezy	lemonsqz.co	Free	5–8%	Handles EU VAT automatically. Good for global audience.
Your own site	Wix / Shopify	Varies	0–3%	Full control. MAAT Lab members can sell through the Wix portal built in Session 3.
Amazon KDP	kdp.amazon.com	Free	30–65%	Massive discovery for low-priced ebooks. Best for \$7–\$9 pricing. Less control.

Your Launch Strategy

You do not need a big launch. You need a real launch — one that tells real people about a real product that solves a real problem. Start with your existing network.

01 Tell Your Network First

Before you go public, message 10–20 people personally. Not a mass email — individual messages. Tell them what you built. Ask if they know anyone who needs it. Offer them a discounted founding price.

02 Post About the Problem (Not the Product)

The week before launch, post content about the problem your ebook solves. Educate. Create urgency. Plant the seed that a solution exists — without announcing it yet.

03 Launch Day Email + Post

Send an email to your list (even if it is 50 people) and post on at least two platforms. Be clear about what it is, who it is for, and what they get. Include a direct link to buy.

04 The 72-Hour Follow-Up

Send a follow-up message to everyone who opened the launch email but did not buy. Answer a common objection. Remind them the offer exists.

05 The Testimonial Ask

After your first 5 buyers, send a personal thank-you and ask: "Can I ask you one question — what made you decide to buy?" Their answer becomes your best marketing copy.

"Stop being a secret to the people who care about you most." Your ebook is the same. Launch it like you believe in it — because you should.

— The Orchard Podcast, Episode 1

APPENDIX

Templates, Checklists & Tools

Checklist A — Ebook Pre-Launch

- Topic validated (3+ competing products exist in the space)
- Reader profile written ("This ebook is for ____ who want to ____ so they can ____")
- Full chapter outline complete (introduction + 5+ chapters + appendix)
- First draft written (all chapters)
- Full edit pass complete (read aloud test applied)
- Cover designed (looks good at 150px thumbnail)
- Internal layout complete (consistent headers, page numbers, fonts)
- All bonuses created and tested
- PDF exported and tested on phone + desktop + tablet
- Platform account set up (Gumroad / Stan / Payhip)
- Product listing created (title, description, price, cover uploaded)
- Payment tested (make a test purchase with your own card)
- Launch email written and tested
- Social launch post written for each platform
- 10 personal network messages drafted and ready to send

Checklist B — Ebook Content Quality

- Every chapter has one clear central idea
- Every chapter ends with a specific action step
- No chapter is longer than it needs to be
- Personal story or example in at least 3 chapters
- Reader's doubt or objection addressed at least twice
- Appendix includes at least 1 template or checklist the reader can use immediately
- CTA in the closing chapter is specific (where to go, what to do)
- All external links tested and working
- Author bio or about page included

■ Copyright notice and legal page included

Template — Ebook One-Page Brief

Ebook Title	_____
Subtitle	_____
Reader Profile	This ebook is for _____ who want to _____ so that they can _____
State A	Where the reader starts: _____
State B	Where the reader finishes: _____
Price	\$_____
Platform	_____
Bonus 1	_____
Bonus 2	_____
Launch Date	_____

Tools Reference

Writing

- Google Docs (free) — drafting
- Hemingway Editor (free) — readability check
- Grammarly (free/paid) — grammar and tone

Design

- Canva (free/paid) — full ebook design
- Adobe Express (free) — covers + layouts
- Designrr (\$27+) — auto-format from Google Doc

Selling

- Gumroad (free, 10% fee) — easiest start
- Stan Store (\$29/mo, 0% fee) — creator-first
- Payhip (free, 5% fee) — bundles + pay-what-you-want

AI Assistance

- Claude at claude.ai — outline, expand, refine
- ChatGPT at chatgpt.com — brainstorm, titles, hooks
- MAAT AI Prompt Vault — 532+ ready prompts for every step

CLOSING

The Product Was Always Inside You.

You picked up this guide because part of you already knew that you had something worth packaging. A lesson. A system. A story. A solution to a problem that someone, somewhere, is searching for right now.

The only thing standing between where you are and a published, sellable digital product is the decision to start — and then the discipline to finish.

You do not need more information. You have it. You do not need a bigger audience. Your network is already built. You do not need permission. This guide is the permission.

"The most radical act of love you can offer in this economy is to teach what you know. Package it. Price it. Send it into the world."

— Sid Morrison Washington · Founder, MAAT

Now close this guide. Open a document. Write the first line of your ebook.

The Lab is waiting.

Join The MAAT Lab

Tools. Templates. Community. Coaching. Everything you need to build your first digital product — and your family legacy — is inside The Lab.

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MAAT · MOOR ASCENSION AND TRIUMPH · TRUTH · JUSTICE · BALANCE · BUILD